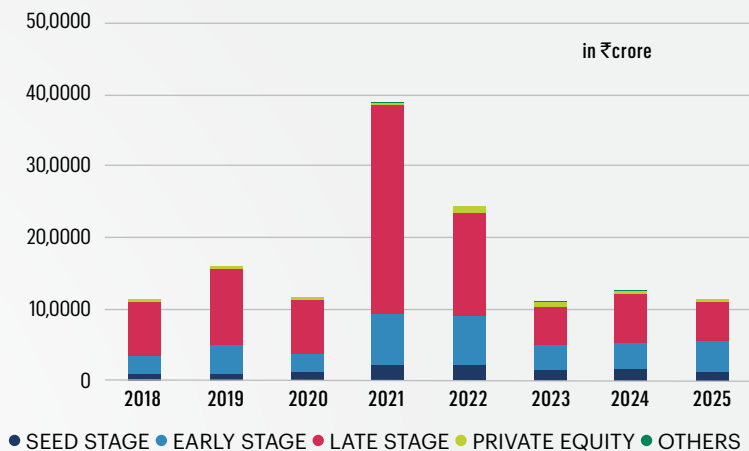




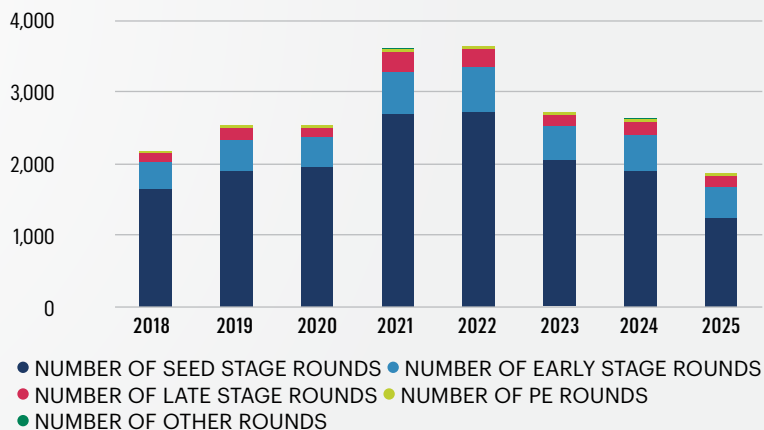
THE MONEY TRAIL

Start-up funding breakdown over the years



FUND CRUNCH

Investors are signing fewer cheques, especially for late-stage start-ups



SOURCE TRACXN

41

ent support—Walmart for Flipkart and Tata Digital for BigBasket—their inclusion in this category highlights tightening liquidity even among large platforms.

Supermarket Grocery Supplies Private Ltd, the flagship entity behind BigBasket, reported a consolidated total income of ₹9,915 crore in FY25 but a net cash outflow of ₹1,360 crore from operating activities against cash reserves of merely ₹78 crore. Flipkart reported an operating cash outflow of ₹4,386 crore, with ₹146 crore in cash balances, according to company financials sourced from CMIE Prowess data.

One month's runway doesn't mean an immediate shutdown, especially for large start-ups like Flipkart and BigBasket, which have a strong parent backing. However, it does highlight extreme dependence on fresh funding, as current cash flows are insufficient to sustain operations without capital infusion at regular intervals.

Other start-ups in this high-risk category include CoinSwitch, ShareChat, and InsuranceDekho, with a runway of less than six months, all of which may need to either raise capital or significantly cut costs. Edtech player Vedantu and digital media firm VerSe Innovation also